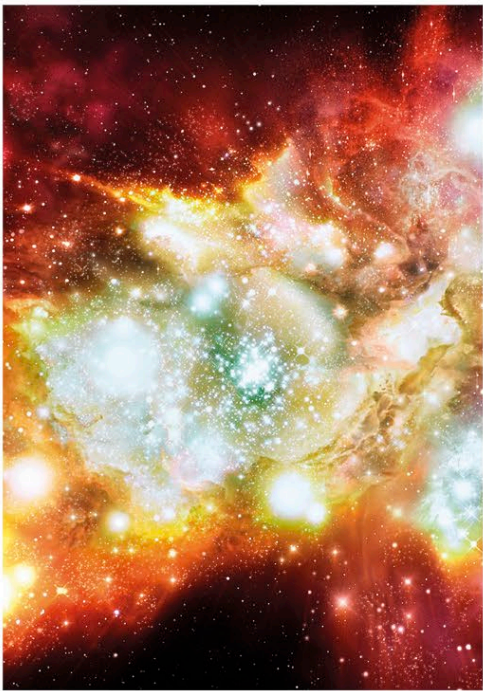


LYNX

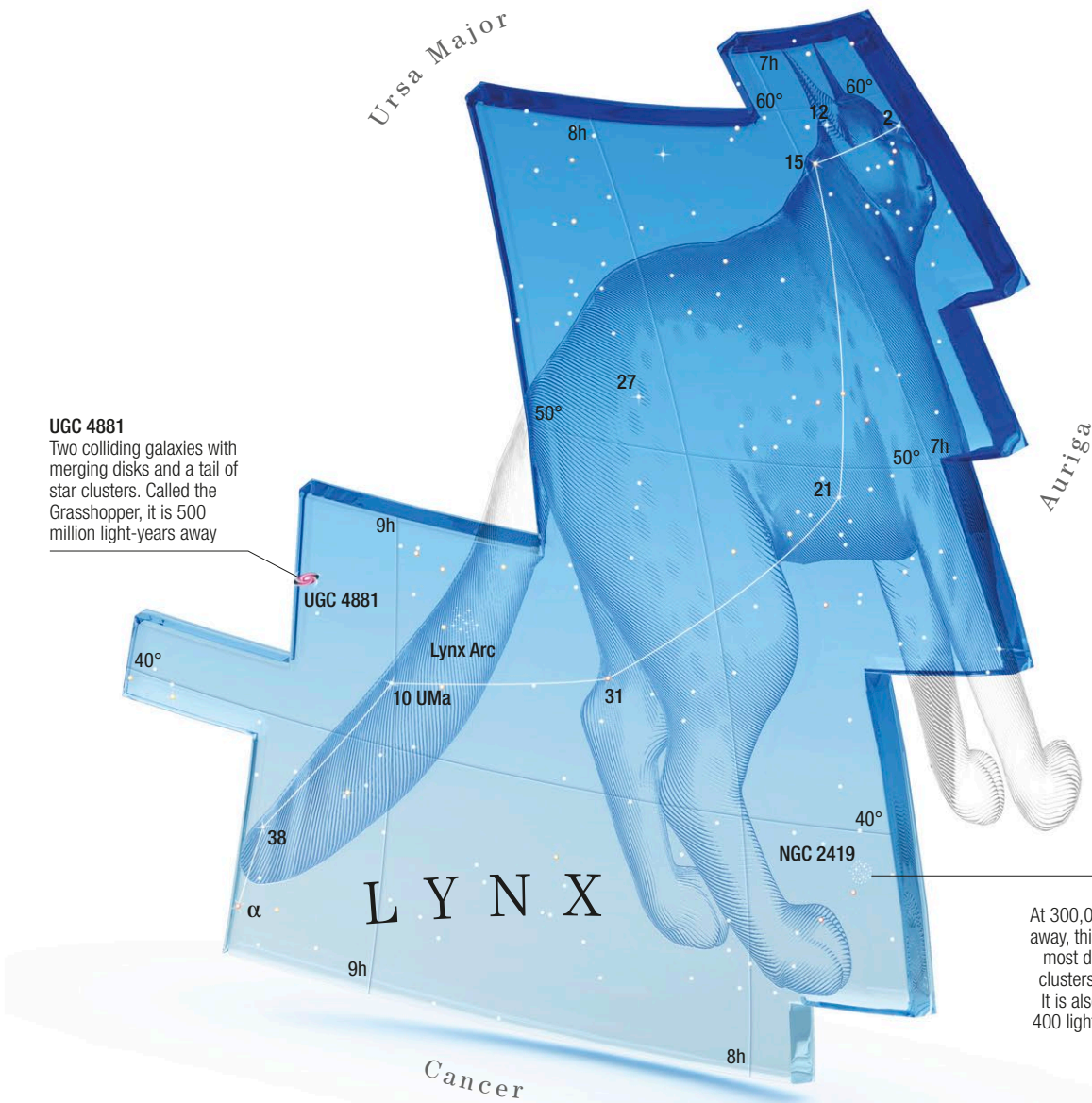
THE LYNX

THIS NORTHERN CONSTELLATION FILLS A BLANK AREA OF SKY BETWEEN URSA MAJOR AND AURIGA. THE LYNX IS DRAWN AROUND A CHAIN OF STARS THAT STRETCHES FROM ITS NOSE TO ITS TAIL.

Johannes Hevelius, the Polish astronomer who defined this constellation in 1687, was renowned for his sharp eyesight. He noted that only those who were as sharp-sighted as cats would be able to see it. Most naked-eye observers will see little more than its brightest star Alpha. With a telescope, interesting double and multiple stars can be seen, such as the triple star 19 Lyncis, which consists of two stars of 6th and 7th magnitude and a wider 8th-magnitude companion. Notable deep-sky objects are the distant globular cluster NGC 2419 and the huge star-forming region known as the Lynx Arc.



◀ **The Lynx Arc**
A vast arc of brilliant light about 12 billion light-years away gives a glimpse back in time to a period of intense star formation. The Lynx Arc is the biggest, brightest, and hottest star-forming region known. It is a million times brighter than the better-known Orion Nebula and contains a million blue-white stars, twice as hot as similar stars in the Milky Way.



KEY DATA	
Size ranking	28
Brightest stars	Alpha (α) 3.1, 38 Lyncis (α) 3.8
Genitive	Lyncis
Abbreviation	Lyn
Highest in sky at 10pm	February–March
Fully visible	90°N–28°S



CHART 6

MAIN STARS	
Alpha (α) Lyncis	Orange giant
☼ 3.1	↔ 203 light-years
5 Lyncis	Optical double star
☼ 5.2	↔ 625 light-years
12 Lyncis	Triple-star system
☼ 4.9	↔ 215 light-years
19 Lyncis	Triple-star system
☼ 5.8	↔ 470 light-years
38 Lyncis	Blue-white main-sequence star and double star
☼ 3.8	↔ 125 light-years

DEEP-SKY OBJECTS	
NGC 2419	Globular cluster
UGC 4881	Pair of interacting galaxies; also called the Grasshopper
Lynx Arc	Star-formation region